

Ancient History





About the Course

Read about ancient history from 100 BC-350 AD through biographies, primary source documents, historical fiction, and history spines. Students will view images, reference maps, and update their Book of Centuries as part of the lessons.

This topic is included in the following course(s): History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.), History: Grades 7-8 (Canada), History: Grade 9 (U.S.), History: Grade 9 (Canada)



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-9	Ancient History: Grades 7-9 1 time/week 30 min	The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church A Short History of Ancient Rome

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)				
	World History: Grades 7-8 U.S. History: Grades 7-8		Ancient History: Grades 7-9 U.S. History: Grades 7-8	
History: Grades 7-8 (Canada)				
	World History: Grades 7-8 Canadian History: Grades 7-8		Ancient History: Grades 7-9 Canadian History: Grades 7-8	
History: Grade 9 (U.S.)				
U.S. History: Grades 9-12	U.S. History: Grades 9-12	Ancient History: Grades 7-9	World History: Grade 9	
History: Grade 9 (Canada)				
Canadian History: Grades 9-10	Canadian History: Grades 9-10	Ancient History: Grades 7-9	World History: Grade 9	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.



∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Ancient History: Grades 7-9



The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church



A Short History of Ancient Rome



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

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or scan the QR
code for links.



Ancient History: Grades 7-9

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any necessary links.
- If you have not read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.
- Decide which lessons/books to read together and which to have students read independently.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Have students give a summary of what they remember. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If the previous passage is difficult to remember, teachers may ask a leading question: "What can you tell me about..." Or students may try looking back at any chapter/section headings or illustrations or reading the first paragraph to jog the memory.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson (often included in lesson plans).
- If necessary, talk about a few unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud or have the student read independently. Sometimes reading for the specified time is a better guide.
- If a book is challenging, try stopping to narrate every now and then rather than waiting until the end. It can also help to read aloud. Or you might want to use an audiobook version of the text and have students read along with it.
- Have students keep an eye out for events or characters to add to their Citizenship Notebook, Book of Centuries, or Copywork Book.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or write a narration.
- Alternatively, students might analyze a character, trace cause to consequence, outline a passage, or use one of the other methods indicated by Charlotte Mason in School Education Chapter 16, especially p.180.
- Students who enjoy writing can experiment with different types of written narrations, but this is not required.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made (orally or in writing).

- You could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question to stimulate discussion. Discussion questions are often included in the lesson plans.



Connect

- Optional: Add something to the Book of Centuries, Century Chart, Citizenship Notebook, or Commonplace book. If students would like to include pictures, these may be drawn or printed.

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

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Term 1

WEEK 1 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 1

Meeting Sulla

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

This year, you are learning about ancient Rome. We are not starting at the beginning with the legend of Romulus and Remus in 753 B.C. We are jumping ahead to 88 BC. The Roman Republic has become a world power. It has marched through the Greek world, razed cities like Carthage, and unseated powerful people. As Pascal Hughes says, "the march of Rome appears unstoppable."

However, what had once been a republic, which enabled certain people to vote in their leadership, was quickly becoming more of a dictatorship, which is where one person assumes absolute power. There were a number of factors that led to Sulla becoming the first dictator in the Roman Republic. He assumed power through political violence, manipulation of land and resources, and military coups. In 88 BC, the Republic found itself in danger.

Sulla's story doesn't start at the beginning of his dictatorship. As you read through Sulla's story, make sure to note any questions that come up from the reading. You can either discuss these questions with someone or write them down.

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Ch.6 p.89-99 - end at "political violence tamed"

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15. Find Carthage, Rome, and any other cities that pop up in your reading to familiarize yourself with the world of Ancient Rome.

• STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries. Mark potential items with a Post-it note as you read so you remember to find something when you sit down to work in your book.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Carthage is razed by Scipio

Aemilianus in 146 BC

Tiberius Gracchus is elected in 133 BC

Sulla becomes dictator in 82 BC

Sulla resigns as dictator in 80 BC and dies in 78 BC

WEEK 2 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 2

Meeting Sulla Continued...

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

Review the timeline at the beginning of the chapter and think back to last week's readings. What do you remember about Sulla?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6 p.99-107 - start at "the Coming Men"

- What in the chapter was surprising to you?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15. Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

• STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries. Mark potential items with a Post-it note as you read so you remember to find something when you sit down to work in your book.

• COMPOSITION

Pretend you are a news reporter interviewing Sulla. What questions would you ask him?

WEEK 3 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 3

Spartacus and a Revolt

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

Rome was built on slavery. In 73 BC, there were more than a million people enslaved in Rome's Italian lands. As Pascal Hughes says, "Some have been bought from foreign merchants, others taken by military conquest,

• IMPORTANT DATES

Spartacus leads his revolt in 73

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

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Term 1

or enslaved as a punishment for criminality. Then there are the unfortunates who were born into bondage, or who are the victims of kidnap by slavers, or who could see no other option in life than to sell themselves into servitude."

However, revolution came to Rome, and it was led by a slave named Spartacus. There are modern-day movies that praise the bravery of this man and those who rose up with him against the powers that shackled them. Spartacus' story is fraught with bravery and peril, yet it left him a legend in the history books. As you read through Spartacus' story, what sticks out to you? Make sure to note any questions that come up from the reading. You can either discuss these questions with someone or write them down.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7 p.110-118 - stop at "Third Servile War"

- How did Spartacus' actions influence the Roman Empire?

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15. Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

WEEK 4 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 4

The Beginning of a Legend

📖 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

Review the timeline at the beginning of the chapter and think back to last week's readings. What do you remember about Spartacus?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7 p.118-126 - start at "To Vesuvius"

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Video Link: From Enslavement to Rebel Gladiator: The Life of Spartacus
Watch the 5-minute video that summarizes Spartacus' revolt and then discuss the similarities and differences between the video and the chapter you've completed.

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15. Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

• STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries. Mark potential items with a Post-it note as you read so you remember to find something when you sit down to work in your book.

WEEK 5 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 5

Introducing Caesar

📖 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

Around the end of the 15th century, William Shakespeare wrote a tragedy titled Julius Caesar. The story of Julius Caesar captured audiences' attention then, and it remains prominent in our modern-day culture. The blood, betrayal, and scandal of the story is what has led to this story's permanence. But as you will read, there is more to this story. Julius Caesar becomes a famous leader for a number of reasons. As you read through the story retold by Pascal Hughes, consider the many reasons Julius Caesar's story might attract so much attention.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8 p.128-137 - stop at "even bigger one"

• EXTRA HELPING

If you have any interest in reading Shakespeare's play Julius Caesar, you can find it at the link provided.

∞ Link: Folger Shakespeare Library: Julius Caesar

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

- Why is Julius Caesar's story so infamous?

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15. Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

WEEK 6 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 6

Caesar's Antics

📖 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

Review the timeline at the beginning of the chapter and think back to last week's readings. What did you learn about Caesar?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8 p.137-152 - start at "Triumvirate"

- What was the most interesting thing in this week's reading?

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15. Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Julius Caesar is assassinated in 44 BC

WEEK 7 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 7

Introducing Octavian

📖 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

With Julius Caesar's death came the question of who would succeed him. That position would fall upon Octavian. But it would not be easy to assume the position, as others would be looking to take his place. Make sure to note any questions that come up from the reading. You can either discuss these questions with someone or write them down.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9 p.154-164 - end at "of the Roman World"

- What was the most interesting thing in this week's reading?

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15. Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

• IMPORTANT DATES

The second Triumvirate is formed in 43 BC

WEEK 8 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 8

Antony and Cleopatra

📖 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

Review the timeline at the beginning of the chapter and think back to last week's readings. What did you learn about Octavian?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9 p.164-172 - start at "Antony and Cleopatra"

- There is much debate in the historical community as to the reasons the Roman Republic fell. What do you think contributed to the fall of the

• STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries. Mark potential items with a Post-it note as you read so you remember to find something when you sit down to work in your book.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Mark Antony and Cleopatra are defeated and both die in 30 BC
History of Rome is written by Livy between 27 BC and 9 BC

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

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Term 1

Roman Empire? → LOCATE 📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15. Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.	Jesus is crucified around 33 AD Jesus resurrects around 33 AD
WEEK 9 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 9 <i>Nero</i> 📖 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World → INTRO Emperor Nero is another famous ruler, but his notoriety comes from the evil that he did as Emperor of Rome. Nero was most known for his murder of anyone who opposed or threatened him. And as Jesus' popularity had increased and his teachings had spread, Nero picked out a new target for his ire: the Christians. Martyrdom under Nero would become infamously horrendous. It is from Nero's time that we have many stories of men and women who died for Christ. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.10 p.174-184 - stop at "this bore Nero." → LOCATE 📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15. Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.	★ TEACHER TIP This chapter may have sensitive content. Depictions of martyrdom are essential to understanding the early church's plight, but Nero is known for his horrific treatment of people whom he saw as enemies. ● IMPORTANT DATES The Great Fire of Rome in 64 AD
WEEK 10 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 10 <i>Nero Continued...</i> 📖 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World → RECAP Review the timeline at the beginning of the chapter and think back to last week's readings. What did you learn about Nero? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.10 p.184-191 - start at "The despot" → LOCATE 📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15. Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.	★ TEACHER TIP This chapter may have sensitive content. Depictions of martyrdom are essential to understanding the early church's plight, but Nero is known for his horrific treatment of people whom he saw as enemies.
WEEK 11 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 11 <i>Catch-Up Day</i> → CATCH UP Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings. Work on your Book of Centuries	● STUDENT TIP Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries. Mark potential items with a Post-it note as you read so you remember to find something when you sit down to work in your book.
WEEK 12 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 12 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: A Short History of Ancient Rome	

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

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Term 2

WEEK 1 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 13

Boudica

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

Transitions of power did not have a large effect on the growth of the empire. Rome kept invading territories, but these people groups resisted. One such group was led by Boudica, who would become famous for her story of rebellion and revenge. Make sure to note any questions that come up from the reading. You can either discuss these questions with someone or write them down.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.11 p.194-200 - end at "list of concerns"

- What was the most interesting thing in this week's reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15. Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

★ TEACHER TIP

This chapter may have sensitive content. Boudica's story is full of peril and contains violence towards women.

● STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries. Mark potential items with a Post-it note as you read so you remember to find something when you sit down to work in your book.

● IMPORTANT DATES

Boudica is killed after her uprising in 61 AD

WEEK 2 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 14

Boudica Continued...

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

Review the timeline at the beginning of the chapter and think back to last week's readings. What did you learn about Boudica?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.11 p.201-211 - start at "Trouble Brewing"

- Discuss Boudica's lasting impact on the Roman Empire.

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15. Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

★ TEACHER TIP

This chapter may have sensitive content. Boudica's story is full of peril and contains violence towards women.

WEEK 3 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 15

Julia Felix

Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

One of the most infamous events in history is the eruption of Mount Vesuvius. There are many scholars and archeologists dedicated to understanding and unearthing the many cities impacted by this eruption. Pompeii is the city most people are familiar with, as it was completely buried. Pompeii was located in the Bay of Naples and had around 10,000-20,000 inhabitants. Make sure to note any questions that come up from the reading. You can either discuss these questions with someone or write them down.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.12 p.214-227

- What impact did Mount Vesuvius' eruption have on the empire?

● STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries. Mark potential items with a Post-it note as you read so you remember to find something when you sit down to work in your book.

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

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Term 2

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15. Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

WEEK 4 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 16

Trajan

📖 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

Who is going to be the most successful emperor of Rome? Pascal Hughes writes, "Ruling from AD 98 to 117, Trajan will become one of the most beloved of all the Roman emperors. A man who conquered new territories, grew the empire as far as anyone would and enriched Rome with awe-inspiring building projects. Indeed, the Senate will welcome future emperors with the wish that they be melior Traiano ('better than Trajan') - evidence that he is to be the benchmark for all who follow." Make sure to note any questions that come up from the reading. You can either discuss these questions with someone or write them down.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.13 p.229-239 - end at "words, best emperor"

- What was the most interesting thing in this week's reading?

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15. Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Pliny writes to Trajan for advice about the Christians in 112 and 113 AD

Trajan grows the empire to its biggest size in 117 AD

Hadrian's Wall is built in 122 AD

WEEK 5 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 17

Trajan Continued...

📖 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

Review the timeline at the beginning of the chapter and think back to last week's readings. What did you learn about Trajan?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.13 p.239-246 - start at "The Peerless Roman Military"

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.4-15. Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

• STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries. Mark potential items with a Post-it note as you read so you remember to find something when you sit down to work in your book.

WEEK 6 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 18

Colosseum

📖 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

As you read about the colosseum in this chapter, think about your familiarity with the colosseum.

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.14 p.247-259

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Virtual Tour of the Colosseum

• IMPORTANT DATES

The Pantheon is constructed in 126 AD

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

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Term 2

Explore the Colosseum virtually.

- Discuss the modern-day Colosseum and the things you learned about it from the virtual tour.

→ LOCATE

📄 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15. Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

WEEK 7 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 19

Severus

📄 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

Pascal Hughes writes, "Almost fifty years earlier, in the African port city of Leptis Magna (in modern day Libya), a high-ranking family welcomes a new baby in 145. The child, Lucius Septimius Severus, reflects Rome's multicultural identity, his mother from an Italian background and his father with Punic, or Carthaginian, heritage. Severus can count consuls among his cousins, while his mother's line are the Fulvia, one of Rome's grand patrician families."

Lucius Septimius Severus would become an emperor of Rome and would be known for creating a military monarchy. As you read more about this emperor, make sure to note any questions that come up from the reading. You can either discuss these questions with someone or write them down.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.15 p.261-270 - stop at "what comes next?"

→ LOCATE

📄 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15. Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Emperor Severus creates a military monarchy 193 AD

WEEK 8 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 20

Severus Continued...

📄 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

Review the timeline at the beginning of the chapter and think back to last week's readings. What did you learn about Severus?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.15 p.270-278 - start at "The Year of the Five Emperors"

→ LOCATE

📄 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15. Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

• STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries. Mark potential items with a Post-it note as you read so you remember to find something when you sit down to work in your book.

WEEK 9 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 21

Zenobia and Decline

📄 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

Pascal Hughes writes, "A crowd has gathered in Alexandria, Egypt, one day around AD 271. Standing on a ceremonial platform beneath a radiant sun is a woman of about thirty, gazing out across the throng assembled in

• IMPORTANT DATES

Emperor Aurelian stems the growing power of Zenobia in the East in 272 AD
Constantine becomes the first Christian emperor of Rome in 306 AD
Rome divides into two empires in 395 AD

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

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Term 2

her honor. Her name is Zenobia, and she is building a reputation for herself as a force to be reckoned with." Make sure to note any questions that come up from the reading. You can either discuss these questions with someone or write them down.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.16 p.279-291 - stop at "in the east"

- Discuss the impact of Zenobia on the Roman Empire.

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15. Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

WEEK 10 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 22

Zenobia and Decline Continued...

📖 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

Review the timeline at the beginning of the chapter and think back to last week's readings. What did you learn about Zenobia and Rome's decline?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.16 p.291-296 - start at "Out of the Shadows"

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15. Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

WEEK 11 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 23

Introducing Helena and Constantine

📖 Materials: A Short History of Ancient Rome, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

What happens when a barmaid meets a lavishly dressed Roman officer named Flavius Constantius? A whirlwind romance, of course! It's not long before Helena and Flavius Constantius make things official, and Helena bears a child who is named Flavius Valerius Constantinus. The child becomes known as Emperor Constantine, the first Christian Emperor. Make sure to note any questions that come up from the reading. You can either discuss these questions with someone or write them down.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.17 p.297-310

- Discuss Constantine and Helena's relationship and how it influenced the Roman Empire.

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.14-15. Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

• STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries. Mark potential items with a Post-it note as you read so you remember to find something when you sit down to work in your book.

WEEK 12 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

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Term 2

Questions will come from:
A Short History of Ancient Rome

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

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Term 3

WEEK 1 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 25

The Christian Revolution

Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ INTRO

How revolutionary was Christianity in the Roman Empire? Jesus' teachings challenged a lot of different ideas that had come to be accepted as truths, such as the belief that women were inferior. Mike Aquilina writes, "Males were superior (a man would say) because women were inferior. It was obvious — so obvious that it hardly needed an argument. Fire is hot, water is wet, and women are inferior to men. This unquestioned and unquestionable truth was the basis of all human society."

So what happens when one of Christianity's most prolific writers challenges this idea in his letters? Think about Galatians 3:28, which reads, "There is neither Jew nor Greek, there is neither slave nor free, there is neither male nor female; for you are all one in Christ Jesus." Paul's words would have registered as an attack on Rome's family values. Paul promotes the idea that women have a place in society, a place in the Bible, and a place in the early church. As you read through this book, we encourage you to take note of anything that stands out, anything you agree with, and anything you disagree with.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1 p.13-26

- Discuss what ideas in the reading stood out to you? Why?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: ∞ Map Link: Europe 200 AD Map
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

• STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries. Mark potential items with a Post-it note as you read so you remember to find something when you sit down to work in your book.

WEEK 2 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 26

Meeting Women in the Early Church

Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ INTRO

At the beginning of this chapter, Mike Aquilina writes, "Jesus of Nazareth specialized in shocking the sensibilities of the religious establishment of his day. It was easy to do, because the establishment was easily shocked. Heal a blind man on the Sabbath, and you've turned the world upside down. But there was hardly anything more shocking than the way he treated women." In the next chapter, you will meet just some of the women in the New Testament who walked alongside Jesus and did ministry along with his disciples. As you read through this book, we encourage you to take note of the named women and their stories.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2 p.27-35 "Jesus of Nazareth" - "its twelve apostles."

- What surprised you in this chapter? Do you agree with the reading? Why or why not?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: ∞ Map Link: Europe 200 AD Map
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

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Term 3

WEEK 3 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 27

Meeting Women in the Early Church

Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ RECAP

What did you read last week? As you read through these sections, we encourage you to take note of the named women and their stories.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.35-46 "Throughout the ministry" - "in her life."

- What other women are missing in the section? Where do you find these women in the Bible?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: ∞ Map Link: Europe 200 AD Map
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

• STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries. Mark potential items with a Post-it note as you read so you remember to find something when you sit down to work in your book.

WEEK 4 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 28

Thecla

Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ INTRO

The story of Thecla was recalled in a text known as the Acts of Paul and Thecla. We have it in many different translations, and it recalls the life and conversion of Thecla, who later became known as a saint. Her story has been met by much incredulity and questions of credibility. Some of Thecla's story will be shared with you in the next chapter. As you read through it, what kind of questions do you have for Thecla?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.46-59 "The story of Thecla" - "in the house."

- What surprised you in this chapter? Do you agree with the reading? Why or why not?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: ∞ Map Link: Europe 200 AD Map
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

• COMPOSITION

On p.48-59, you'll read Thecla's stories. Choose one of the stories and summarize it in your own words.

• EXTRA HELPING

If you are interested in reading the complete story of Thecla as told in the Acts of Paul and Thecla, visit the link.

∞ Link: The Acts of Paul and Thecla

WEEK 5 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 29

Perpetua and Felicity

Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ INTRO

Perpetua lived in the time of Emperor Septimius Severus. Mike Aquilina wrote that Septimius Severus "wasn't persecuting Christians per se at the moment, but he had made it a capital crime for Roman citizens to become Jews or Christians." Perpetua was a noblewoman and was able to write and read. She converted to Christianity and was sentenced to die with her servant Felicity. Her story is different from other accounts because it was written by her own hand. As you read through it, what kind of questions do you have for Perpetua and Felicity?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.60-67 "Perpetua is almost" - "had willed it."

• IMPORTANT DATES

Perpetua and Felicity martyred in 203 AD

• STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries. Mark potential items with a Post-it note as you read so you remember to find something when you sit down to work in your book.

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

- What surprised you in this chapter? Do you agree with the reading? Why or why not?

→ LOCATE

📄 Map Resource: ∞ Map Link: Europe 200 AD Map
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

WEEK 6 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 30

St. Blandina

📄 Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ RECAP

What did you read last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.67-73 "Blandina was a slave" - "to wild beasts."

- What surprised you in this chapter? Do you agree with the reading? Why or why not?

→ LOCATE

📄 Map Resource: ∞ Map Link: Europe 200 AD Map
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• STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries. Mark potential items with a Post-it note as you read so you remember to find something when you sit down to work in your book.

WEEK 7 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 31

St. Agnes

📄 Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ RECAP

What did you read last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.73-80 "Of all the ancient" - "subject of Hercules"

- What surprised you in this chapter? Do you agree with the reading? Why or why not?

→ LOCATE

📄 Map Resource: ∞ Map Link: Europe 200 AD Map
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

WEEK 8 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 32

St. Agnes Continued...

📄 Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ RECAP

What did you read about last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.80-87 "Prudentius" - end of chapter

- You've met many women from many different stations who were martyred for their faith. Which one stood out to you the most and why?

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: ∞ Map Link: Europe 200 AD Map
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

WEEK 9 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 33

The Poets and Thinkers

📖 Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ INTRO

Mike Aquilina writes at the beginning of the chapter, "There were a few pagan women who earned fame as poets or philosophers, but they were very few. We can't say that women were commonly poets and philosophers among the Christians either, but the number seems to have been significantly higher." In the next section, you'll learn about St. Macrina, St. Marcella, St. Paula, St. Eustochium, and St. Monica. All of these women were poets and thinkers. As you read through it, what kind of questions do you have for these women?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.89-101 "There were a few" - "to preserve it."

- What surprised you in this chapter? Do you agree with the reading? Why or why not?

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: ∞ Map Link: Europe 200 AD Map
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

WEEK 10 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 34

Marcella and Paula

📖 Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ RECAP

What did you read about last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.101-120 "Marcella herself was" - "and my readers."

- What surprised you in this chapter? Do you agree with the reading? Why or why not?

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: ∞ Map Link: Europe 200 AD Map
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

• STUDENT TIP

Be sure to add some people, events, and drawings of artifacts to your book of centuries. Mark potential items with a Post-it note as you read so you remember to find something when you sit down to work in your book.

WEEK 11 📅 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 35

St. Monica

📖 Materials: The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

→ RECAP

What did you read about last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.121-132 "It might seem" - "from the body."

- You've met many women from many different stations who were poets and thinkers. Which one stood out to you the most and why?

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ LOCATE

🗺 Map Resource: ∞ Map Link: Europe 200 AD Map
Locate the various places mentioned in your readings.

WEEK 12 🗓 30m Ancient History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

The Witness of Early Christian Women: Mothers of the Church

Ancient History: Grades 7-9

Examination

Term 1

- From A Short History of Ancient Rome: How did the Roman Republic fall?
- From A Short History of Ancient Rome: Which of the emperors you read about had the most impact on Ancient Rome? Explain your answer with three examples of their accomplishments.

Term 2

- From A Short History of Ancient Rome: How did conquered nations react to Rome? Use examples from the reading.
- From A Short History of Ancient Rome: What led to the decline of the Roman Empire?

Term 3

- The Witness of Early Christian Women: Choose a woman in the New Testament and explain how she benefited the church and how she maneuvered through a culture that devalued her.
- The Witness of Early Christian Women: Choose a woman from either the martyrs and heroines or poets and thinkers section and summarize her story.